Year 9 Admission Assessment

Version 2, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.
Do your best.
It is fine if you cannot answer every question.
Your teacher will tell you when to start each part.

How to answer

Tick one box.

Which one is a fruit? a chair ☐ an apple ☑ a bus ☐

Write your answer in the box.

12 + 8 = **20**

Show your working. You can get marks for your working, even if your answer is wrong.

Working
4 × 25 = 100, 100 + 30 = 130

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Listening	A conversation and a short talk. Answer 16 questions.	10 minutes
Reading	Read three texts. Answer the questions.	15 minutes
Writing	Write a story or an article.	10 minutes
Break		5 minutes
Maths	Fluency, word questions and applied problems.	25 minutes
Science	Questions with pictures, tables and graphs.	8 minutes

You may use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler.
You may use a calculator **only** in Maths Section C.

Listening

There are two parts: **A** and **B**.

Your teacher will read each part **two times**.

Before each part, you have one minute to read the questions.

Listen carefully. You can answer while you listen, or after.

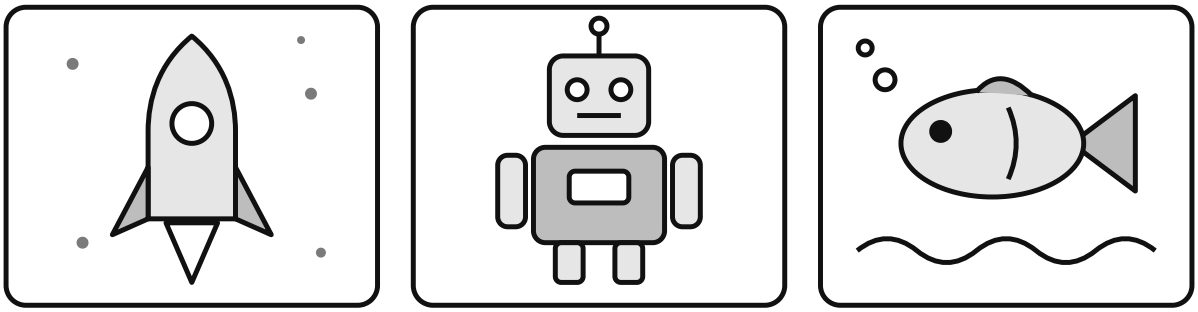
Part A

You will hear two friends talking.

1 / 1

What is the new exhibition about?

Tick one picture.

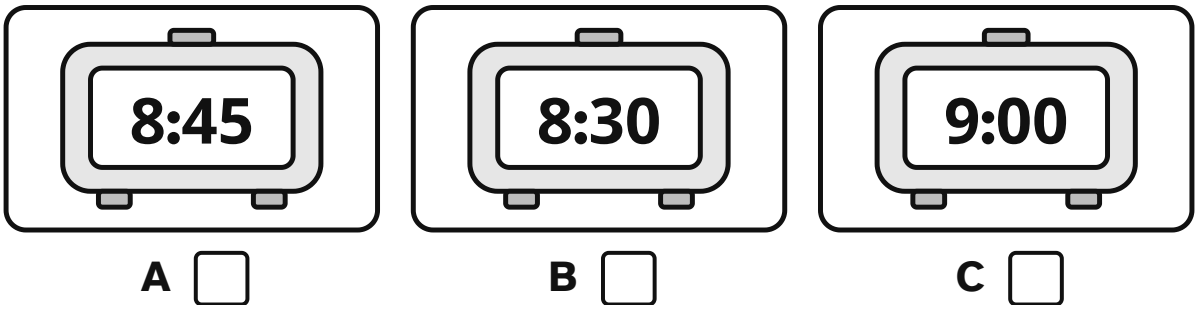


A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

2 / 1

What time do they meet at the school gate?

Tick one clock.

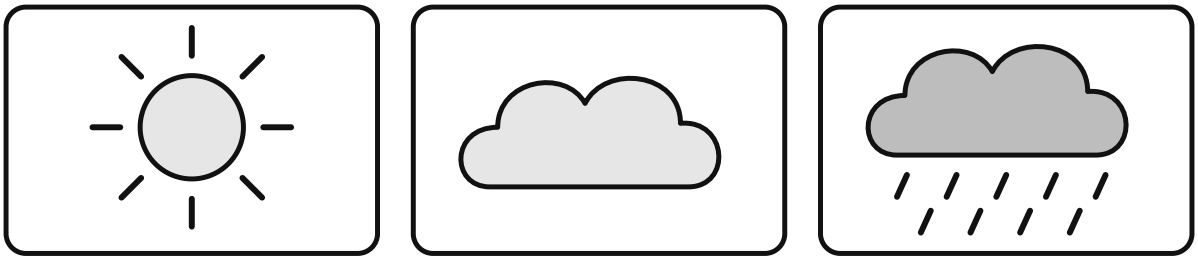


A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

3 / 1

What will the weather be like in the afternoon?

Tick one picture.



A ☐ B ☐ C ☐

4 / 1

How much does lunch in the museum café cost?

☐ yuan

5 / 1

What must everyone bring to get a free ticket?

☐

6 / 1

What time do they get back?

☐

7 / 1

Mei says, "Most of the day is inside, anyway."

What does she mean?

Tick one.

- ☐ The rain will not be a big problem.
- ☐ They will not go to the museum.
- ☐ Tom must stay at home.

8 / 1

Why does Mei tell Tom about Jun?

Part B

You will hear a short talk about tea. A scientist, Dr Lin, is talking to a class.
You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16 first.
Part B is harder. Do as much as you can.

9 / 1

What is the main purpose of Dr Lin's talk?
Tick one.

- ☐ To tell the story of the emperor Shennong.
- ☐ To explain where tea came from and why there are different kinds.
- ☐ To show that green tea is better than black tea.

10 / 1

Dr Lin tells the story of the emperor Shennong.
What does she think about this story?
Tick one.

- ☐ It is the best evidence we have about where tea began.
- ☐ It is a nice story, but it may not be true.
- ☐ Historians have proved that it is wrong.

11 / 1

Lu Yu wrote the first book about tea. When did he write it?

more than ☐ years ago

12 / 1

When did Dutch traders bring the first tea to Europe?

in the early ☐

13 and 14

/ 2

Complete the notes.

Write one to three words in each gap.

Example

Green tea, black tea and oolong all come from the same **plant** .

Notes: the science of tea

13 Pickers take only the top two leaves and the _____ .

14 Oxidation: chemicals in a crushed leaf react with _____ in the air.

15

/ 1

How is black tea made?

Write 2, 3 and 4 in the boxes to show the order of the steps.

Step 1 is done for you.

1 The leaves are withered: they are spread out until they go soft.

_____ The leaves are dried.

_____ The leaves are left in warm air.

_____ The leaves are rolled to break them.

16

/ 1

In English, people say "tea", not "cha".

Use the talk to **explain** why.

Reading

There are three parts: **A**, **B** and **C**.
Each part is harder than the one before.
Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.
You have 15 minutes. When you finish, wait for your teacher.

Part A

Read the poster. Then **answer** questions 1 to 7.

Greenhill Sports Centre

Summer activities for ages 12 to 16

	Activity	Day	Time	Price
	Basketball	Monday and Wednesday	16:00 to 17:30	¥20
	Swimming	Tuesday and Thursday	15:30 to 16:30	¥25
	Table tennis	Saturday	9:00 to 11:00	¥15
	Climbing	Saturday	14:00 to 16:00	¥40
	Yoga	Sunday	10:00 to 11:00	Free

- Swimming: please bring a swimming cap.
- Climbing: ages 13 and over only.
- Book at the front desk or on our app.
- Open every day, 8:00 to 21:00.

1 / 1

Which activity is on Tuesday and Thursday? _____

2 / 1

How much does table tennis cost? _____

3 / 1

Which activity is free? _____

4 / 1

What must you bring to swimming? _____

5 / 2

Tick True or False for each sentence.

Sentence	True	False
The centre is open every day.	☑	☐

Sentence	True	False
Basketball is on Saturday.	☐	☐
Climbing finishes at 16:00.	☐	☐
You can book on the app.	☐	☐
Yoga is in the evening.	☐	☐

6 / 1

Wang Hao is 12 years old. Can he go climbing?

Tick one. Then **write** why.

☐ Yes ☐ No

Why? _____

7 / 1

Li Na is free only on Saturday mornings.

Which activity can she do? _____

Part B

Read the story. Then **answer** questions 8 to 14.

Halfway Up

From the ground, the climbing wall had looked easy. Now, eight metres up, Mei was not so sure.

Her right hand was on a small red hold, no bigger than a coin. Her left foot rested on a ledge so narrow that only her toes fitted on it. Below her, the sports hall had gone strangely quiet. She could hear her own breathing, fast and loud.

"You're doing great, Mei!" That was Coach Zhang, who was holding her rope. His voice sounded very far away.

Mei looked up. The next hold was a blue one, just out of reach. To get it, she would have to let go with one hand and push up hard with her legs. For one terrible second, she would be holding on with almost nothing.

She had done this move a hundred times at training, two metres above a soft mat. It was exactly the same move. That was what she told herself. Her body did not believe her.

Her arms began to shake. Sweat made her fingers slippery. She thought about the other girls in the competition, who had all reached the top. She thought about how easy it would be to shout "Lower me down!" and float gently back to the floor. Nobody would really blame her.

Then a small voice called out from somewhere near the door. "Go on, Mei!"

It was Bo, her little brother. He was six, and he was standing on a chair so that he could see. Mum was holding on to the back of his T-shirt. He was waving a sign made from a cereal box. In wobbly letters, it said: MEI CAN FLY.

Mei almost laughed. Something tight in her chest seemed to loosen. She breathed out slowly, bent her knees and pushed.

Her fingers closed around the blue hold.

Five moves later, she slapped the top of the wall, and the quiet hall exploded into noise.

8 / 1

How high up the wall is Mei at the start of the story? _____

9 / 1

"Her body did not believe her." What does this sentence mean?

Tick one.

- ☐ Mei's body was too tired to climb.
- ☐ Mei knew the move was easy, but she still felt afraid.
- ☐ Mei did not know how to do the move.

10 / 2

Write two things from the text that show Mei was frightened.

1. _____
2. _____

11 / 1

The writer tells us that the other girls "had all reached the top".

Why do you think the writer tells us this?

_____

_____

12 / 1

Why did Mei almost laugh when she saw Bo's sign?

_____

_____

13 / 1

"the quiet hall exploded into noise"

What does "exploded" mean in this sentence?

_____

14 / 1

How do Mei's feelings change from the start of the story to the end?

_____

_____

Part C

Read the text. Then **answer** questions 15 to 21.
In this text, a woman remembers a summer from her childhood.
Part C is hard. Do as much as you can.

Before the Cranes Came

Every summer until I was twelve, I was sent to stay with my grandmother in Willow Lane, a narrow seam of grey brick that ran between two of the busiest roads in the city. From the main road you would never have guessed it was there. You turned past a shop selling phone cases, ducked under a tangle of electric cables, and suddenly the roar of the traffic fell away, as if someone had closed a heavy door behind you.

Grandmother's house was the fourth on the left. It had one room downstairs, one room upstairs, and a courtyard no bigger than a dining table, where she grew chives and spring onions in chipped enamel basins. Everything in the lane happened in public. Neighbours washed vegetables on their doorsteps, argued over games of chess, and hung their washing on lines strung from wall to wall, so that a trip to the shop meant ducking under other people's shirts. At the time, I found it all slightly embarrassing. My school friends lived in towers with lifts and security guards; I spent my holidays in a place where everyone knew what you had eaten for breakfast.

The notice went up in the spring of my twelfth year. It was pasted, a little crooked, on the wall beside the public tap, and it explained in polite official language that Willow Lane would be "redeveloped". Grandmother read it twice, folded her arms, and announced that it was about time. "Proper pipes," she told the neighbours. "Hot water that comes out of the wall. Imagine." She said it so often, and so loudly, that I believed her.

That last summer, she was busier than I had ever seen her. She scrubbed the courtyard as though important visitors were expected. She gave away her bicycle, her wooden stools and most of her basins, and she refused every offer of help. Yet every evening, when the heat finally lifted, she carried a folding chair to the end of the lane and sat there until it was dark, watching the swifts slice through the air above the rooftops. She never said what she was looking at, and I never thought to ask.

On moving day, forty years of her life fitted into the back of a small van, with room to spare. The new flat was on the twenty-third floor. It had white walls, a balcony and a view so wide that the old district looked like a child's model, already half swallowed by building sites. Grandmother praised everything: the lift, the shower, the gas cooker that lit with a single click. She praised it all in the same bright voice that she used for my first attempts at cooking, which should have told me something.

The text continues on the next page.

Before the Cranes Came (continued)

It was months before I noticed the balcony. She had lined it with the three enamel basins she had kept, and in them, against everyone's advice, she was growing chives, which leaned bravely into the wind. Beside the basins sat a single grey brick. When I asked her about it, she shrugged and said it was useful for holding the door open. The balcony door, as far as I could see, had never needed holding.

I am older now than my mother was then, and I have lived in several flats with lifts. I understand things about that summer that I could not understand at twelve: that cheerfulness can be a kind of hard work, and that a person can be pleased and heartbroken at the same time. The cranes came and went. Where Willow Lane used to be, there is now a shopping centre with a fountain that plays music on the hour. I have been inside only once. I stood beside the fountain for a long time, trying to work out where the fourth house on the left had been, and found that I could not.

15 / 1

"Everything in the lane happened in public."
Explain in your own words what this means.

16 / 1

"She said it so often, and so loudly, that I believed her."
What does this suggest about Grandmother's real feelings?
Explain how the words show this.

17 / 1

"when the heat finally lifted"
What does "lifted" mean in this phrase?

18 / 1

"the old district looked like a child's model, already half swallowed by building sites"
What does the word "swallowed" suggest about what is happening to the old district?

19 / 1

Why do you think Grandmother kept the grey brick?
Give one piece of evidence from the text.

20 / 1

How does the writer feel about Willow Lane now, as an adult?
Explain your answer with evidence from the text.

21 / 2

Summarise how Grandmother dealt with leaving Willow Lane.
Write two or three points in your own words.

Writing

Choose one task: A or B.

Tick the box for the task you choose.

Plan your ideas in the plan box. Then **write** on the lines.

You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can.

Task A: a story ☐

Write a story that begins with this sentence:

> When I opened my bag, I found something that was not mine.

Ideas: What did you find? Whose was it? What did you do? How did the story end?

Task B: an article ☐

Your school magazine asks this question:

> Should every school day include one hour of sport?

Write an article for the magazine. Give your opinion and at least two reasons.

Ideas: health, friends, time for study, examples from your own life.

Plan

Notes and ideas (this part is not marked)

Your writing

Task A ☐ Task B ☐

Maths

You have 25 minutes. Do as much as you can.

There are three sections: **A**, **B** and **C**.

Write your answer in the box. **Show** your working in the working box.

Your teacher can read any question to you.

Sections A and B: you may **not** use a calculator.

Section C: you **may** use a calculator.

Section A: Fluency (no calculator)

What the maths words mean

Simplify: $3a + 5a = 8a$

Expand: $3(x + 2) = 3x + 6$

Factorise: $x^2 + 5x = x(x + 5)$

Standard form: $4500 = 4.5 \times 10^3$

Make *x* the subject: $y = x + 4$, so $x = y - 4$

1 / 2

(a) **Write** 2^{-3} as a fraction.

(b) **Simplify** $(2x^3)^2$

2 / 2

Work out $(3 \times 10^4) \times (5 \times 10^{-7})$

Give your answer in standard form.

Working

3 / 2

Expand and simplify $(2x - 3)(x + 4)$

Working

4 / 1

Factorise $x^2 - 2x - 15$

5 / 2

Solve the simultaneous equations.

$2x + 3y = 7$

$5x - 2y = 8$

Working

$x =$ $y =$

6 / 1

Make x the subject of the formula $y = \dfrac{3x - 2}{5}$

Working

$x =$

Section B: Word questions (no calculator)

These questions are in words only. **Read** each one carefully.
You can **write** an equation, then **solve** it.

Example: write an equation, then solve it

Mei is 3 years older than Jun. Their ages add up to 29. How old is Jun?

Let Jun's age be j. Then Mei's age is $j + 3$.

Equation: $j + (j + 3) = 29$

Solve: $2j + 3 = 29$, so $2j = 26$, so $j = 13$

Answer: Jun is 13 years old.

7 / 2

A printer prints 84 pages in 6 minutes.
It always prints at the same speed.
How long does it take to print 210 pages?

Working

[ ] minutes

8 / 2

In a sale, every price is reduced by 20%.
Amir pays ¥96 for a pair of trainers in the sale.
What was the price of the trainers before the sale?

Working

¥ [ ]

9 / 2

3 pens and 2 notebooks cost ¥26 altogether.
1 pen and 4 notebooks cost ¥32 altogether.
All the pens are the same price. All the notebooks are the same price.
Work out the cost of one pen and the cost of one notebook.

Working

One pen: ¥ [ ] One notebook: ¥ [ ]

10 / 2

A rectangle is 3 cm longer than it is wide.

Its area is 40 cm².

The width of the rectangle is w cm.

Write an equation in w. Then **solve** it to find the width.

Working

Equation: ☐

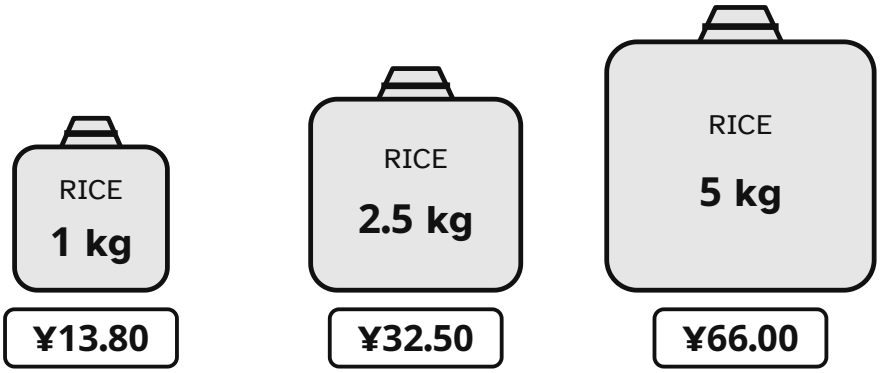
Width = ☐ cm

Section C: Applied problems (you may use a calculator)

Each problem has more than one step. **Show** your working.

11 / 2

A shop sells rice in three sizes.



Which bag is the best value for money? **Show** how you decide.

Working

Tick one. ☐ 1 kg ☐ 2.5 kg ☐ 5 kg

12

/ 2

Li Na has ¥5000. She wants to save it for 4 years.
She can choose one of two bank accounts.

	Account A	**Account B**
Interest	3% **simple** interest per year	2.6% **compound** interest per year
How it works	Each year, the bank adds 3% of the ¥5000 that she put in.	Each year, the bank adds 2.6% of the money in the account at that time.

Which account gives Li Na more money after 4 years? **Show** your working.

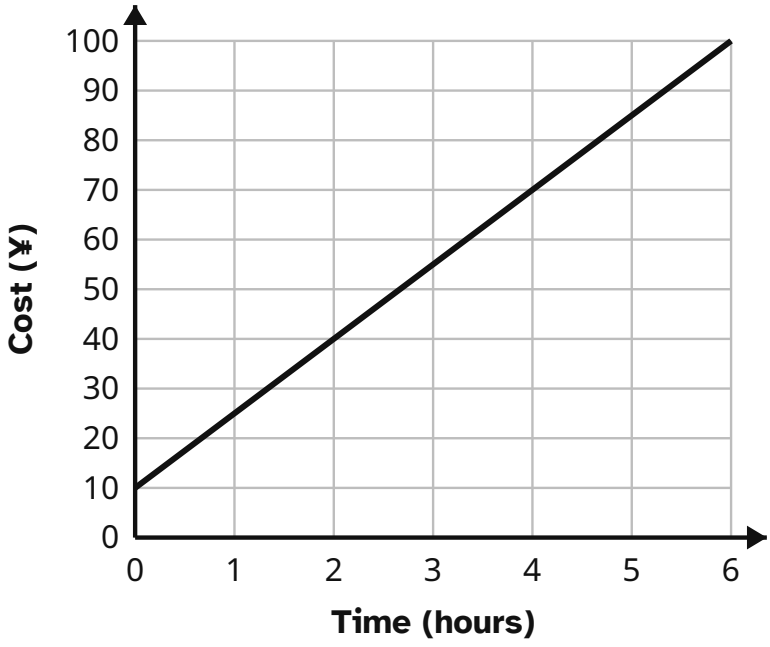
Working

Tick one. ☐ Account A ☐ Account B

13

/ 2

A bike hire company charges a fixed fee, plus an amount for each hour.
The graph shows the cost of hiring one bike.



(a) **Work out** the gradient of the line.

(b) **Explain** what the gradient tells you about the cost of hiring a bike.

14

/ 3

A water tank is a cylinder.

The diameter is 80 cm and the height is 120 cm.

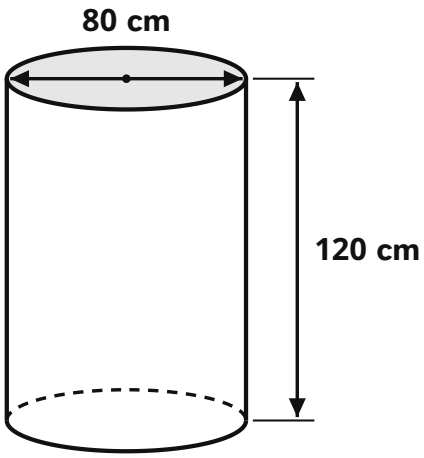
The tank is empty. Water flows in at 15 litres per minute.

How long does it take to fill the tank?

Give your answer to the nearest minute.

1 litre = 1000 cm^3

Not drawn accurately



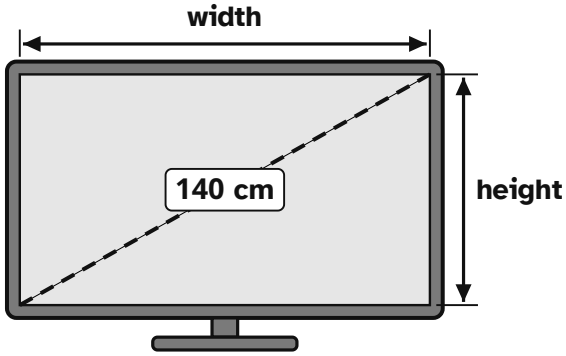
Working

[ ] minutes

15

/ 3

TV screens are measured along the diagonal.
This TV screen has a diagonal of 140 cm.
The width and the height of the screen are in the ratio 16 : 9.



Not drawn accurately

Show that the width of the screen is about 122 cm.

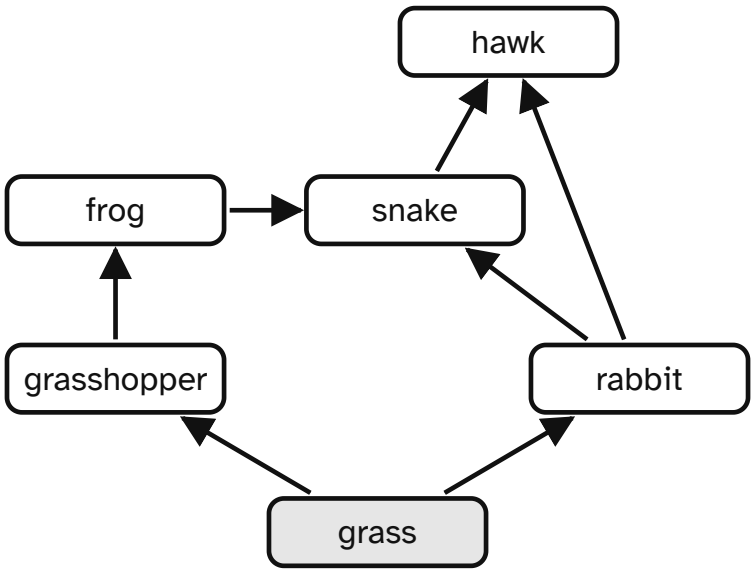
Working

Science

You have 8 minutes. Do as much as you can.
Your teacher can read any question to you.

1 / 2

This is a food web. An arrow means "is eaten by".



(a) **Write** the name of the producer. ☐

(b) The number of frogs goes down. What happens to the number of grasshoppers?

☐ It goes up. ☐ It goes down. ☐ It stays the same.

Explain why.

2 / 1

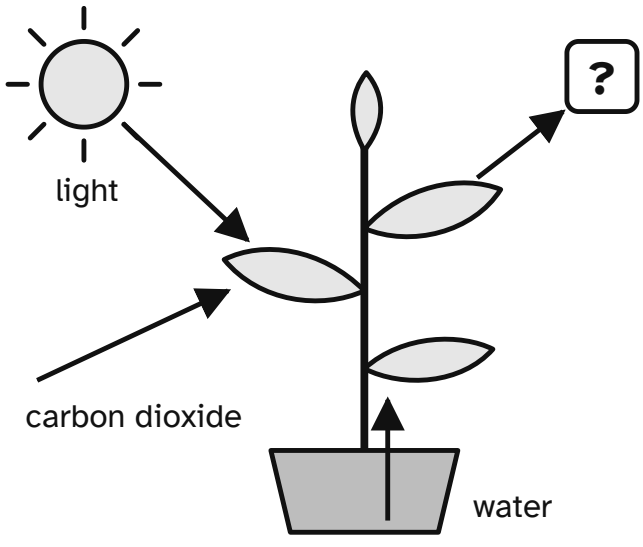
Plants make glucose by photosynthesis.

A gas comes out of the leaf (**?** in the picture).

Complete the word equation.

carbon dioxide + water

→ glucose + ☐

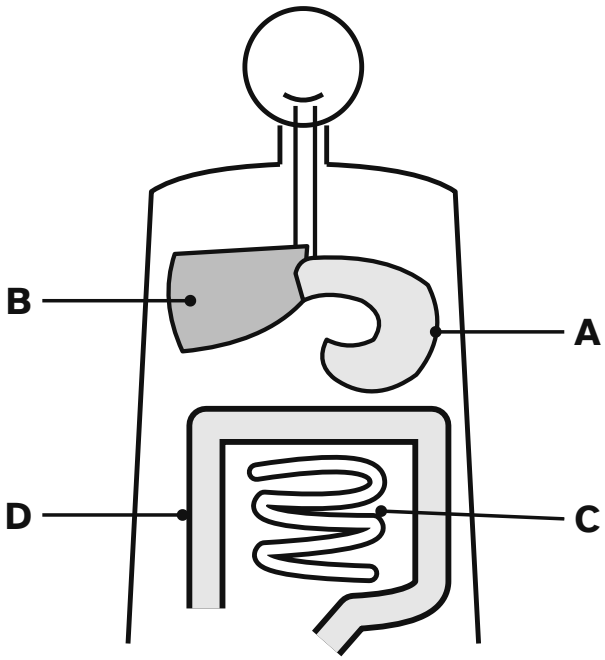


3 / 1

This is the human digestive system.

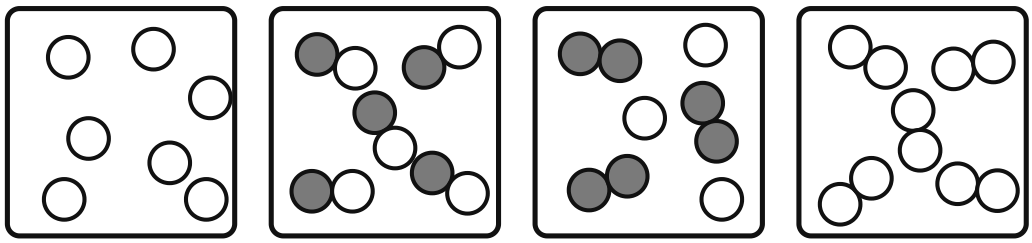
Where is most digested food absorbed into the blood?

Write the letter.



4 / 2

Each circle is an atom. Atoms of different elements have different shading.

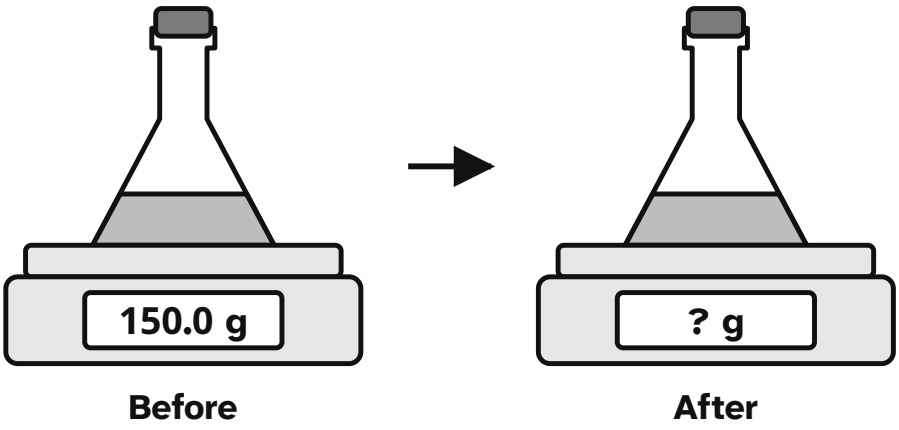


(a) Which box shows a **compound**? **Write** the letter.

(b) Which box shows a **mixture**? **Write** the letter.

5 / 1

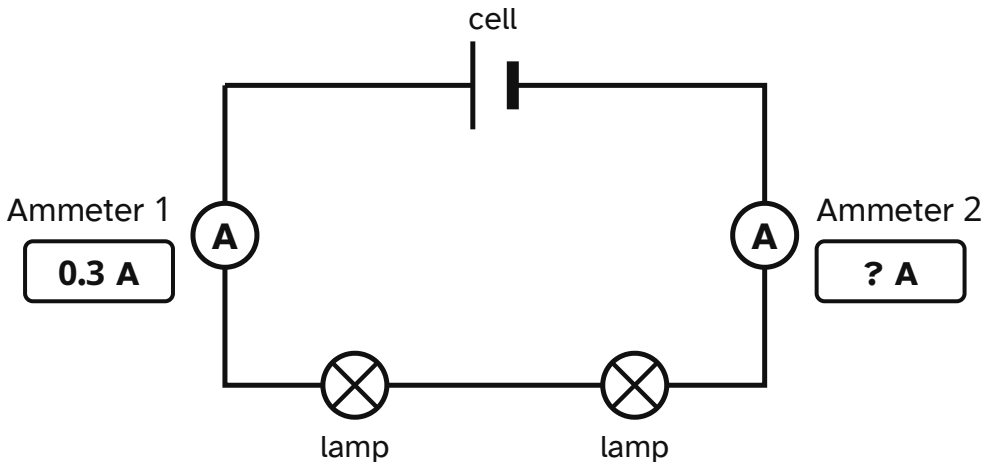
Wang Hao puts two chemicals in a flask. He closes the flask, so nothing can get in or out. The chemicals react.



What does the balance read **after** the reaction? _____ g

6 / 1

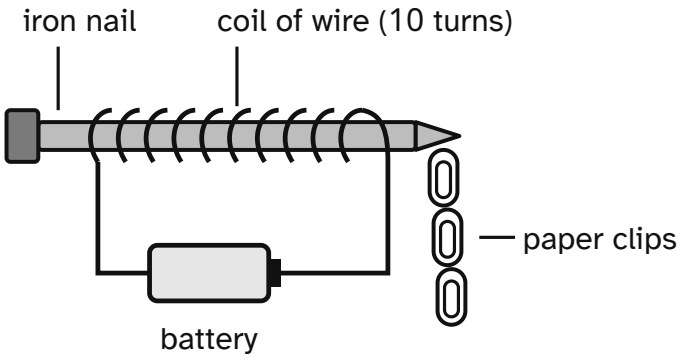
This is a series circuit. Ammeter 1 reads 0.3 A.



What does ammeter 2 read? _____ A

7 / 2

Wang Hao makes an electromagnet. He changes the number of turns of wire on the nail. He counts how many paper clips the nail picks up.



Number of turns of wire	**10**	**20**	**30**	**40**
Number of paper clips	3	6	9	?

(a) **Write** one thing he must keep the same to make it a fair test.

(b) **Predict** the number of paper clips for 40 turns. ☐

Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 9 Admission Assessment v2: assessor booklet

Version 2, October 2026. Use with `Y09_Student_Paper_v2`; it replaces version 1. New in version 2: an academic listening talk (listening Part B), a demanding literary text (reading Part C) and a harder maths paper that reports fluency, word questions and applied problems separately. The writing, the science and the interview are unchanged.

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 9** (age 13 on 1 September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 7 (初一)**; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 8. Ask the student and the family which grade and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs between textbooks and regions. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. The student's level of English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E), their maths and science against the UK Year 8 curriculum (what a Year 9 student should know on entry), and, through the interview, who they are, their future plans and their suitability for the programme. Version 2 is harder at the top, to separate competent (D) from fluent (E) students and to place strong mathematicians accurately.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		This booklet
2	Listening: Part A conversation (1 to 8), Part B academic talk (9 to 16) (16 marks)	10	Assessor reads the scripts (3.1)	Pages 2 to 5; pencil	Student paper
3	Reading paper: Parts A, B and C (24 marks)	15	Student alone	Pages 6 to 12	
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student alone	Pages 13 to 14	
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths: A Fluency, B Word questions, C Applied problems (30 marks)	25	Student alone; you may read any question aloud	Pages 15 to 20; pencil, rubber, ruler; **scientific calculator in Section C only**; no protractor	
7	Science: 7 questions (10 marks)	8	Student alone; you may read any question aloud	Pages 21 to 24; no calculator	
8	Interview, opening with the Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 8**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card; a plain card to cover sentences	Sentence Reading Record; Interview Record Years 7 to 10
	Total	**about 90**		A clock; a scientific calculator for each student	Candidate Summary and Decision

Files: `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) can run at the same time with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 7) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1.

Planning note. At a natural classroom pace, reading both listening texts twice takes about 9 to 10 minutes, so with the reading time before each part the listening often runs to about 12 minutes. Allow 12 minutes in the timetable.

2. Before you start

Room and materials. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them. **Calculators:** one scientific calculator per student for maths **Section C only**. Keep calculators out of reach until the student reaches Section C (in a group, hand them out when you say "Section C"), and collect them before the science. A phone may not be used as a calculator.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. You can use a calculator only in the last part of the maths, Section C. Please write all your answers in English. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	Maths and science
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Count the L questions in the score summary: they are evidence about English.
Answers	**In English only.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**In English only:** numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Calculator	Not allowed.	Maths Section C only (a scientific calculator). Not allowed in maths Sections A and B or in science.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them in the score summary.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Listening:** read both parts to every student; in a group, never stop the reading for one student. Part B is meant to stretch. A student who found Part A very hard may sit quietly through Part B: say once, "It is fine to leave Part B."
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it. Do not move them on to Parts B and C.
- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed.

- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly. Version 2 is harder at the top on purpose: tell the student before the reading paper and the maths that the last part is meant to be difficult.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 10 minutes, 16 marks)

There are two parts. **Part A** (questions 1 to 8) is the version 1 listening, unchanged: an everyday conversation. **Part B** (questions 9 to 16) is new: a short academic talk at the level of a lesson for a fluent English speaker of 13 to 14. Each part is read twice.

Part A. Say: "Turn to the Listening page. There are two parts. First, Part A. You will hear two friends, Mei and Tom, talking about a science club trip. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 1 to 8." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part A script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again.

Part B. Say: "Now turn to Part B. You will hear a scientist, Dr Lin, giving a short talk to a class about tea. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 9 to 16. You can also finish Part A." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part B script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace (about the speed of a teacher talking to a class). In Part A, say each speaker's name before their line, a little more quietly, both times. In Part B, read as a teacher gives a short lesson: clearly and with natural stress, but without slowing down for the numbers, the dates or the subject words. At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat lines or explain anything. Part A takes about 2 minutes per reading and Part B about 3 minutes per reading.

Script: Part A, planning the Saturday trip

Mei: Hi, Tom. Are you coming on the science club trip on Saturday?

Tom: Yes, I am. But I've lost the letter. Where are we going again?

Mei: To the Science and Technology Museum. The robot exhibition has finished, but there's a new exhibition about space. They've got a real rocket engine! [pause]

Tom: Cool. What time do we meet?

Mei: At half past eight, at the school gate. The coach leaves at a quarter to nine, so don't be late. [pause]

Tom: What's the weather going to be like?

Mei: Cloudy in the morning, and rain in the afternoon. Bring an umbrella. [pause]

Tom: Do I need to bring any money?

Mei: The museum ticket is free for students. Lunch in the museum café costs forty yuan, or you can bring a packed lunch. [pause]

Tom: I'll bring my own lunch. My grandma makes amazing dumplings.

Mei: Oh, and Mr Zhang says everyone must bring their student card. You can't get a free ticket without it. [pause]

Tom: OK. When do we get back?

Mei: At about five o'clock. [pause]

Tom: Five o'clock? That's a long day. I hope it doesn't rain too much.

Mei: Most of the day is inside, anyway. [pause]

Tom: Oh no, my student card! I think it's still in my PE bag. I'd better check tonight.

Mei: Good idea. Last time, Jun forgot his card, and he had to wait at the ticket office for twenty minutes while Mr Zhang phoned the school.

Tom: Poor Jun. I don't want that to happen to me. See you on Saturday! [pause]

Part A answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear (for example "studen kard"). This applies to Part B too.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**A** (the rocket: space)		B (robots: the exhibition that has finished)
2	**B** (8:30)		A (8:45 is when the coach leaves)
3	**C** (rain)		B (cloudy is the morning)
4	**40** (yuan)	forty; ¥40	
5	**(their) student card**	student ID; school card; card	ticket; money; umbrella
6	**(about) five o'clock**	5; 5:00; 17:00; five; 5 pm	8:30 or 8:45
7	**The rain will not be a big problem.**		
8	**To warn Tom, or to remind him why he must bring his card**	Any answer that shows what happened to Jun because he forgot his card (he had to wait 20 minutes), or that Mei does not want the same thing to happen to Tom	"Jun is her friend"; "Jun was late"; an answer about lunch or dumplings

Script: Part B, a short talk about tea (Dr Lin, a scientist, talking to a class)

Good morning, everyone. Today I want to answer two questions: where did tea come from, and why are there so many different kinds? [pause]

After water, tea is the most popular drink in the world, and its history begins in China. According to a famous legend, nearly five thousand years ago, the emperor Shennong was boiling water under a tree when a few leaves drifted into his pot, and he liked the taste. It's a charming story, and a very convenient one for an emperor. What historians can show for certain is much more recent. [pause] In the Tang dynasty, more than twelve hundred years ago, a scholar called Lu Yu wrote the first book entirely about tea, explaining how to grow, prepare and serve it. [pause]

From China, tea spread in two directions. Merchants carried it over land to Central Asia, Russia and the Middle East, while European ships later carried it by sea. Dutch traders brought the first tea to Europe in the early fifteen hundreds. Actually, no, I've got my dates wrong: it was the early sixteen hundreds, about a hundred years later. They bought it from merchants from Fujian, on China's south-east coast, and from the Netherlands it later reached Britain. [pause]

Now for the science. Surprisingly, green tea, black tea and oolong all come from exactly the same plant, an evergreen bush called Camellia sinensis. Pickers take only the top two leaves and the bud, which is the tiny leaf that hasn't opened yet. [pause]

> The difference between the teas comes from a process called oxidation. When a leaf is crushed, chemicals inside it react with oxygen in the air, and the leaf gradually turns brown, just like a sliced apple. [pause] To make green tea, workers heat the leaves soon after picking, in a hot pan or with steam. The heat stops oxidation, so the leaves stay green and taste fresh. Black tea, on the other hand, is first withered, which means it is spread out until it goes soft. Next, it is rolled to break the leaves, then left in warm air until it is fully oxidised. Finally, it is dried. As a result, black tea is darker and stronger. Oolong, however, is only partly oxidised, so it sits somewhere in between. [pause]
>
> One last puzzle: in Fujian, the local word for tea sounds like "te". Countries that received their tea by sea mostly use a word like "tea", whereas countries that received it over land say something like "cha" or "chai". So the name of your drink may tell you which way the tea travelled. [pause]

About the Part B script (for the English team). 427 words in 27 sentences: an average sentence of about 16 words. About 19% of the words are outside the 2000 most common word forms of English (about 13% if names are left out and simple word endings are matched, the method in `02_Listening_Evidence_Statement`, Section 6). It explains a process (oxidation and how black tea is made) and a cause and effect (heat stops oxidation, so green tea stays green); compares green, black and oolong tea, and the land and sea routes; uses numbers and dates; explains subject words in context (bud, oxidation, withered); implies an opinion (that the Shennong legend may not be true); corrects itself ("Actually, no, I've got my dates wrong"); and uses the discourse markers however, whereas, on the other hand and as a result.

Part B answers (1 mark each; questions 13 and 14 are one gap each). The questions follow the order of the talk.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Main idea: the speaker's purpose	**To explain where tea came from and why there are different kinds.**		"To tell the story of the emperor Shennong" (one detail from the start: the student has not followed the whole talk). "To show that green tea is better than black tea" (the talk compares the teas but never says one is better).
10	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**It is a nice story, but it may not be true.**		"The best evidence we have" (the student took the legend as fact and missed "a very convenient one for an emperor" and "What historians can show for certain is much more recent"). "Historians have proved that it is wrong" (too strong: Dr Lin doubts it but does not say it has been disproved).
11	Specific detail: a number	**1200** (more than twelve hundred years ago)	twelve hundred; 1,200	5000 (the legend). 120 or 12 000 (the number was heard but not understood as "twelve hundred").
12	Specific detail: a date, after a correction	**1600s** (the early sixteen hundreds)	sixteen hundreds; the seventeenth century; 1600; about 1610	**1500s** or fifteen hundreds: the date Dr Lin corrects. The student heard the first date but not "Actually, no, I've got my dates wrong". This is the key error to note.
13	Note completion: a subject word explained in the talk	**(the) bud**	budd (any spelling that is clearly bud); "the tiny leaf"; "the leaf that has not opened"	leaf or leaves alone; flower; top; tea
14	Note completion: a subject word	**oxygen**	oxigen, oxgen (clearly oxygen); O_2	air (already in the sentence); oxidation; water; steam

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
15	Process: the order of steps	**Rolled 2, left in warm air 3, dried 4** (withered 1 is given)		All three numbers must be right for the mark. "Dried" before "left in warm air" shows that "Finally, it is dried" was missed.
16	Inference that joins two parts of the talk	**Tea came to Britain by sea** (Dutch ships brought it from Fujian merchants, and in Fujian the word sounds like "te"), and countries that got tea by sea use a word like "tea"	Any answer that links how tea reached Britain or England (by sea, by ship, from the Dutch, from Fujian) with the name: "Britain got it by sea"; "it came from Fujian, where they say te"; "the Dutch brought it from Fujian by ship"	"English people like tea"; "cha is a Chinese word"; "tea is easier to say". The rule alone ("countries that got tea by sea say tea") with nothing about how tea reached Britain: the link is the inference.

Band guide v2

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A** New to English
Part A 3 to 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C** Developing competence
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

Part A places bands A to C; Part B separates C, D and E. If the result is uneven (for example Part A 5 or 6 but Part B 3 or more), use judgement and check against listening in the interview.

What to look for

- **Part A.** Questions 1 to 3 check the main points, each with a distractor (robots, 8:45, cloudy); 4 to 6 need exact detail; 7 and 8 need implied meaning. A student who gets 1 to 6 but not 7 and 8 follows everyday talk but not yet what is meant. A wrong answer that is a distractor (8:45, B in question 3) shows the student heard words but not how they connect ("leaves at", "in the morning").
- **Part B.** Questions 11 to 15 need details, subject words and a sequence heard in a longer talk; questions 10 and 16 need what is implied or what joins two parts of the talk. A student who scores 3 to 5, with 10 and 16 wrong, follows the content of a lesson but not yet the speaker's meaning: usually D. Fluent listeners usually get the correction in question 12 and the inference in question 16.
- **Stamina.** A student who answers questions 9 to 12 well but leaves the later questions blank may have lost concentration in a three-minute talk, rather than not understood it: note it, and check in the interview.
- Compare with listening in the interview (how much of your English the student understood). If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check: some students freeze in a test, and some hide gaps in conversation with good routines.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 24 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are three parts, A, B and C. Each part is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. Part C is hard: do as much as you can. You have 15 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "in your own words". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

What changed from version 1. Part A is the version 1 Part A (the poster). Part B is the version 1 Part C ("Halfway Up"), renumbered as questions 8 to 14. Part C is new: a literary memoir above the age-expected level. The version 1 Part B (pandas) is not used.

Part A: sports centre poster (very accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	Swimming	1	swim
2	¥15	1	15; 15 yuan
3	Yoga	1	
4	A swimming cap	1	cap; swim hat. Do not accept "money" or "student card".
5	False, True, True, False	2	All four correct: 2. Three correct: 1. Two or fewer: 0 (two is the score from guessing).
6	**No** and a reason: climbing is for ages 13 and over; he is too young; he is only 12	1	Both parts needed. "No" alone: 0.
7	Table tennis	1	Climbing is on Saturday afternoon, so "climbing" does not score.

Part B: "Halfway Up" (fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 13; version 1 Part C, questions renumbered)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	Retrieval	Eight metres	1	8 m; 8. Do not accept 2 metres (the training height).
9	Vocabulary and meaning in context	"Mei knew the move was easy, but she still felt afraid."	1	
10	Retrieval and inference	Any **two** of: her arms shook; sweat made her fingers slippery; her breathing was fast and loud; she wanted to be lowered down or give up; "one terrible second"; she was "not so sure"; the coach's voice sounded far away; something tight in her chest	2	1 mark each, own words or quotation. Do not accept "she looked up" or "she was eight metres up" alone.
11	Author's purpose	To show the pressure on Mei: she does not want to be the only one who fails; she feels she must reach the top too	1	To make the reader worry that she will fail; to make her feel worse or more nervous. Do not accept a retelling with no purpose ("because they reached the top").
12	Inference	The sign was funny or sweet (her little brother made it; "MEI CAN FLY"), and it made her feel better	1	Either idea: it was funny or cute; her brother's support cheered her up or made her less nervous. Do not accept "she was happy" with no reason.
13	Vocabulary in context	It suddenly became very loud; everyone started cheering at once	1	very loud; suddenly noisy; people shouted and clapped. Do not accept a literal explosion or "something broke".
14	Inference across the text	From frightened or nervous (start) to happy, proud, relieved or confident (end)	1	Both ends needed.

Part C: "Before the Cranes Came" (literary memoir, about 650 words, above the age-expected level; for a fluent reader of 13 to 14 it is demanding). An adult remembers the last summer before her grandmother's lane was knocked down. The point of view must be inferred: the grandmother's cheerfulness hides her sadness, and the writer understands this only as an adult.

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
15	Explanation in own words	People did their everyday, private things outside, where everyone could see them: there was no privacy	1	Any own-words explanation that daily life was done openly, or that everyone saw or knew what everyone else was doing. An example in the student's own words is fine if it explains the idea ("people washed food and played chess outside, so everyone saw everything"). Do not accept the sentence copied, "everything happened", or an example copied from the text with no explanation.
16	Inference with evidence	She was not really happy to leave (she was sad, worried or unsure) and was trying to persuade herself or other people; she says it "so often" and "so loudly", as if she needs to convince someone	1	Both parts needed: a feeling that is not simple happiness (sad, unsure, pretending, hiding her feelings) and a reason from the words (she repeats it; she says it too loudly). "She was happy about the hot water" scores 0: it takes her words at face value.
17	Vocabulary in context	The heat went away; it became less hot; it got cooler	1	eased; faded; went down; ended. Do not accept "rose", "went up", "picked up" or "was raised" (the usual meaning of lift).
18	Effect of the writer's language	"Swallowed" makes the building sites sound like a huge mouth or animal eating the old district: it is disappearing quickly and completely, and nothing can stop it	1	Any answer that explains that the old district is being eaten up, destroyed, taken over or lost. Better answers add the feeling it creates (sad, threatening, helpless). Do not accept "the building sites are big", or "it means eaten" with no link to the district.
19	Inference with evidence	As a reminder of her old home: a piece of Willow Lane that she could keep. Evidence: her reason is not true, because the balcony door "had never needed holding"; or the brick is grey like the lane ("a narrow seam of grey brick"); or she also kept the basins and grew chives as she did in the lane	1	Both parts needed: a reason (memory, missing her home, a piece of the lane) and one piece of evidence. "To hold the door open" scores 0: it is her excuse, and the writer shows that it is not true.
20	Writer's viewpoint	She misses the lane and feels sad or a sense of loss that it has gone; she values it now, although she found it embarrassing as a child. Evidence: she tried to find where the house had been and "found that I could not"; she has been into the shopping centre only once; she now understands her grandmother's feelings	1	A feeling and a piece of evidence are both needed. Accept nostalgic, regretful, fond, sad that it has gone. Do not accept "embarrassed" (how she felt as a child) or "she likes the shopping centre".
21	Summary in own words	Any two of: (1) she told everyone she was pleased and praised the new flat, hiding her sadness behind cheerfulness; (2) she kept herself busy: cleaning, giving away her things, refusing help; (3) she quietly said goodbye to the lane, sitting at the end of it every evening until dark; (4) she kept reminders of her old home: the basins, the chives and the brick	2	1 mark for each different point, up to 2. Two examples of the same point (cleaning and giving things away) score 1. Long copied sentences with no selection score 1 at most.

Band guide v2 (use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 3 to 5	**C** Developing competence
Part B 6 to 8 with Part C 0 to 4	**D** Competent
Part B 6 to 8 with Part C 5 to 8	**E** Fluent

What to look for

- **Part B** ("Halfway Up") is the age-appropriate text: 6 or more shows a competent reader of age-level fiction. **Part C** is above the age-expected level: a fluent reader of 13 to 14 usually scores 5 or more.
- **Strong readers** in Part C explain in their own words (questions 15 and 21), read beneath the surface (16 and 19: the grandmother's cheerfulness is a performance, and the brick is from the lane), comment on the effect of a word (18), and see that the adult writer feels differently now (20). Retrieval-only answers in Part C, with the inference questions blank, usually mean band D, not E.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy, Part C blank or copied lines that do not answer the question. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Parts B and C may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the sentence reading record.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out. A student who answers everything they reach correctly but does not reach Part C may be a slow but accurate reader: give a band by judgement and say so.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (narrative): a story that begins "When I opened my bag, I found something that was not mine." Task B (opinion): an article for the school magazine, "Should every school day include one hour of sport?", with an opinion and at least two reasons. The plan is not marked.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 13 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the story stops rather than ends, or the article lists reasons without explaining them.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Story: an opening that follows on from the given sentence, a problem, some description or tension, an ending. Article: a clear opinion, two or more reasons with examples or explanation, a conclusion; suits a magazine reader.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("good", "very", "nice"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary, some ambitious words used correctly; a range of linking words (however, although, as a result, suddenly); topic words (fitness, stress, concentrate).
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types, including complex sentences (when, although, which, if); tenses controlled (past tense in the story); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; full stops, commas, question marks, apostrophes and (in a story) speech marks used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 9 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 60 to 120 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing.
D	An organised piece (often 120 to 200 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 13 year old usually writes 150 to 250 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with a clear opening and ending, a range of sentence types used for effect, controlled tenses, precise and sometimes ambitious vocabulary, and mostly accurate spelling and punctuation. The story has a voice and some suspense; the article sounds like an article (it speaks to the reader, gives reasons and examples, and ends with a conclusion).

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Once upon a time", "Nowadays, with the development of society") followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- A student who plans well (clear notes in the plan box) but writes little may have the ideas but not yet the English: note it, because it points to good progress with support.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

Use `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10` for the interview and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` for the sentence reading. Both are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 9 starts at **Level 8 (sentence 22)**. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring on the record. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block on the form, including **future plans and aspirations** and the suitability strands. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English.
- **Speaking band:** circle it on the interview record, using the descriptors there, and copy it to the score summary below. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 25 minutes. There are three sections. In Sections A and B, you may not use a calculator. In Section C, you may use a calculator. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can, and look at every page. Section C is meant to be hard." Give the calculator only when the student reaches Section C. Give a two-minute warning.

The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words mean (simplify, expand, factorise, standard form, make *x* the subject), and the example at the start of Section B shows how to write an equation from words. They are there so that an English word does not hide maths the student knows.

Sections. There are no floor questions: every question is at or above the expected level for entry to Year 9.

- **Section A, Fluency** (questions 1 to 6, 10 marks): calculation and algebra with no context; **no calculator**. It starts at the top of the Year 8 expected content (index laws, standard form) and goes into early Year 9 (negative indices, double brackets, factorising quadratics, simultaneous equations, rearranging).

- **Section B, Word questions** (questions 7 to 10, 8 marks): problems given only in words, with no diagram; **no calculator**. The student must decide what to do and usually form an equation (direct proportion, a reverse percentage, simultaneous equations from a context, a quadratic from an area).
- **Section C, Applied problems** (questions 11 to 15, 12 marks): multi-step problems in real contexts with a picture, a table, a graph or a diagram; **a scientific calculator is allowed**. Best value, simple and compound interest, a real-life graph (what the gradient means), a cylinder with a flow rate, and Pythagoras with a ratio. Question 13(b) is an **Explain** question; question 15 is a **Show that** question in an unfamiliar context (how TV screens are measured).

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark, ft = follow through (allow the mark for correct work with the student's own earlier wrong value). A correct answer with no working gets full marks, except in questions 11, 12 and 15, where the working is part of the answer. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English (an explanation in Chinese scores 0).

Calculators. Many Chinese middle schools do not allow calculators, so some students are slow with one. A calculator is allowed in Section C, not required: every Section C question can be done by hand (with π = 3.14 in question 14). Do not count it against a student who works by hand.

What a Year 9 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 7 (初一)**: operations with negative numbers, algebraic expressions, linear equations, simultaneous linear equations, linear inequalities, angles and parallel lines, square roots and coordinates. **Linear and simultaneous equations and inequalities are usually strong.** Grade 8 (初二) topics **may not have been taught yet**: zero and negative indices, multiplying out double brackets, factorising, Pythagoras' theorem and linear functions (gradient). Quadratic equations are Grade 9 (初三). Textbooks differ: 北师大版 teaches index laws and multiplying polynomials in the second term of Grade 7, 人教版 in Grade 8, so ask which book the student used. Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
Section A: Fluency (no calculator)				
1	Negative index; power of a product	(a) 1/8 (b) $4x^6$	(a) B1. Accept 0.125. −8 or −6 score 0 (the negative power read as "minus"): note it. (b) B1. $2x^6$ (only x^3 squared) or $4x^5$ (indices added) score 0: note it.	(a) Negative indices are Grade 8 (负整数指数幂): may not have been taught. (b) Powers of products (积的乘方) are Grade 8 in 人教版, Grade 7 in 北师大版: may not have been taught.
2	Standard form calculation with a negative power	1.5×10^{-2}	M1 for 15×10^{-3} or 0.015 seen; A1 for 1.5×10^{-2}. 15×10^{-3} as the final answer: M1 only (not standard form). 1.5×10^{-3} with no correct working: 0.	Standard form for large numbers is Grade 7 (科学记数法); with negative powers it is Grade 8: may not have been taught.
3	Expanding double brackets	$2x^2 + 5x - 12$	M1 for at least three of the four terms $2x^2$, $+8x$, $-3x$, -12; A1 for the simplified answer.	Multiplying polynomials (多项式乘多项式) is Grade 8 in 人教版, Grade 7 in 北师大版: may not have been taught. Single brackets are secure.
4	Factorising a quadratic	$(x - 5)(x + 3)$	B1, either order. $(x + 5)(x - 3)$ scores 0 (it expands to $x^2 + 2x - 15$): note "sign error".	Factorising a trinomial (十字相乘法) is often taught only with quadratic equations in Grade 9, or as enrichment: may not have been taught.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
5	Simultaneous equations (a multiplier is needed)	$x = 2$, $y = 1$	M1 for a correct method to eliminate one letter (for example $4x + 6y = 14$ and $15x - 6y = 24$, so $19x = 38$), or a correct substitution; A1 for both values.	Usually secure (Grade 7, 二元一次方程组). A student from a Chinese school who loses these marks is weaker in algebra than the rest of the profile may suggest.
6	Rearranging a formula	$x = (5y + 2)/3$	B1. Accept $5y/3 + 2/3$, $(2 + 5y) \div 3$ or any equivalent. A part-way step ($5y = 3x - 2$, or $3x = 5y + 2$) does not score: note it.	The algebra is Grade 7 (等式的性质) and usually secure; the English "make x the subject" may be new, which is why the example box explains it.
Section B: Word questions (no calculator)				
7	Direct proportion: a rate	15 minutes	M1 for 14 pages per minute, or $210 \div 84 = 2.5$ (then × 6), or $6 \div 84$ minutes per page; A1 for 15.	Secure (Grade 6, 正比例).
8	Reverse percentage	¥120	M1 for $96 \div 0.8$, or $96 \div 80 \times 100$, or $0.8x = 96$, or 80% = ¥96; A1 for 120. An answer of 115.20 (96×1.2, adding 20% back on) scores 0: note it. It is the most common error, and shows the reverse step is not understood.	Usually secure: discounts (打折, "八折") and finding the original price are common in Grade 6 and in Grade 7 equation problems.
9	Simultaneous equations from a context	One pen ¥4, one notebook ¥7	M1 for two correct equations ($3p + 2n = 26$ and $p + 4n = 32$, any letters) or a systematic trial that uses both facts; A1 for both values.	The maths is secure (Grade 7); the test is forming the equations from English sentences.
10	Forming and solving a quadratic from an area	Equation $w(w + 3) = 40$ (or $w^2 + 3w - 40 = 0$); width **5 cm**	B1 for a correct equation in w. B1 for 5, from factorising ($(w + 8)(w - 5) = 0$) or from trying values ($5 \times 8 = 40$). If both 5 and −8 are given as the width, the second mark needs −8 to be rejected.	Quadratic equations are Grade 9 (一元二次方程): may not have been taught. The width can be found by trying values, so a strong student can still score both marks.
Section C: Applied problems (calculator allowed)				
11	Best value: unit price	The **2.5 kg** bag	M1 for at least two correct values that can be compared: price per kg (¥13.80, ¥13.00, ¥13.20), or kg per yuan (0.0725, 0.0769, 0.0758), or the price of the same mass (for 5 kg: ¥69, ¥65, ¥66); A1 for 2.5 kg with all three compared correctly. The tick alone, with no working, scores 0.	Secure (unit price, 单价, Grades 4 to 6). Many students expect the biggest bag to be the best value; here it is not.
12	Simple and compound interest	**Account A** (¥5600, against ¥5540.63 in Account B)	M1 for a correct compound interest method for Account B: 5000×1.026^4, or year by year 5130, 5263.38, 5400.23, 5540.63 (5540.64 if each year is rounded to 2 decimal places), or ¥540.63 interest. A1 for both amounts correct (A ¥5600 or ¥600 interest; B ¥5540.63, accept ¥5540.64, ¥5540.6 or ¥5541) and Account A chosen. Account A worked out on its own scores 0 (simple interest is the familiar part). Simple interest at 2.6% for B (¥5520) shows the table was not read: 0, even with Account A ticked. Compound interest at 3% for A (¥5627.54) with B correct: M1 A0.	Simple interest is Grade 6 (利率). Compound interest is usually met only in Grade 9 (增长率, $(1 + x)^2$) or later: may not have been taught. The table explains how each account works, so a careful reader can work year by year.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
13	Real-life straight-line graph: the gradient and what it means	(a) **15** (b) The cost goes up by **¥15 for each extra hour** (the hire charge is ¥15 per hour)	(a) B1. Accept 15 yuan per hour. (b) B1 for an explanation in context: per hour, with a value (ft their (a)). "The line goes up" or "it is steep" scores 0. "The fixed fee is ¥10" is the intercept, not the gradient: 0 for (b), but it shows the graph was read.	Linear functions and gradient are Grade 8 (一次函数): may not have been taught. A student who does not know the English word "gradient" may still explain the cost per hour: mark (b) on its own.
14	Volume of a cylinder; units; a rate	**40 minutes**	M1 for the volume $\pi \times 40^2 \times 120$ (603 186 cm^3, or 0.603 m^3, or 603 litres); M1 for dividing by 1000 and by 15, or equivalent (ft their volume); A1 for 40. Accept 40.2. $\pi = 3.14$ gives 40.19: accept 40. Using 80 as the radius gives about 161: M0 M1 A0, note "diameter used as radius".	Cylinder volume is Grade 6 (圆柱的体积) and litres and cm^3 Grade 5: usually secure. Errors are usually the radius or the unit conversion.
15	Pythagoras with a ratio: **Show that**, unfamiliar context	Width = $16 \times 140 \div \sqrt{337}$ = **122.02** cm, which is about 122 cm	M1 for using Pythagoras with the ratio: $(16k)^2 + (9k)^2 = 140^2$, or $337k^2 = 19\,600$, or the diagonal of a 16 by 9 rectangle is $\sqrt{337} = 18.36$, or $w^2 + (9w/16)^2 = 140^2$; M1 for $k = 7.626$ (or the scale factor $140 \div 18.36$, or $w^2 = 14\,889$); A1 for 122.0 or 122.02 seen (more accurate than 122; 122.1 from k rounded to 7.63 is fine). A complete check that starts from 122 (height $122 \times 9 \div 16 = 68.6$, and $\sqrt{(122^2 + 68.6^2)} = 140.0$) with a conclusion also scores 3. "122" with no working scores 0. Sharing 140 in the ratio 16 : 9 (89.6 cm) scores 0: note it.	Pythagoras' theorem is Grade 8 (勾股定理): may not have been taught. Ratio is secure (Grade 6). This is a ceiling question for the strongest students.

Totals: Fluency (Section A) / 10; Word questions (Section B) / 8; Applied problems (Section C) / 12; total / 30.

Band guide v2 (provisional, for a harder paper): 0 to 10 (under 35%): **1** Below expected; 11 to 16 (35 to 54%): **2** Working towards; 17 to 22 (55 to 74%): **3** Expected; 23 to 30 (75% or more): **4** Greater depth, likely top set. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Reading the three sub-scores

As a rough guide, "high" is about three quarters of a section or more, and "low" is under half.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
High Fluency, low Word questions	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read one or two of the word questions aloud in English, then, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark L). If the student then solves them quickly, record an English barrier: it points to English support in maths lessons, not to a lower maths set.
High Fluency and Word questions, low Applied	Secure content, but less practised at multi-step problems, choosing a method and explaining.	The student needs teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. It is not a reason for a lower set.
Low Fluency	Gaps in calculation and algebra, or several NT topics.	Check the NT notes: if most of the lost marks are NT questions (questions 1 to 4), write the likely band once taught in the summary.
Applied as high as, or higher than, Fluency	Good reasoning with some gaps in technique or untaught algebra.	Usually NT topics in Section A; check before placing lower.

Not tested this year (not enough time): scatter graphs, two-way tables and tree diagrams, bearings, similar shapes, depreciation, inequalities. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for placement.

What to look for

- **Word questions.** A student who defines letters and writes equations ("Let p be the cost of a pen") is ready for English-medium maths. A student who writes only numbers but gets the answers has the maths; check in the

interview whether they can explain a method in English.

- **Applied problems.** Look at whether the student chooses a method without being told (unit price, year-by-year interest, volume then litres, Pythagoras with a ratio). The Explain in 13(b) and the Show that in 15 show whether the student can communicate maths in English. Many students from Chinese schools calculate quickly and accurately but leave out working: that is a habit, not a weakness, but in a Show that question the working is the answer.
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (simultaneous equations, percentages, unit price, cylinder volume), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions, write the likely band once taught in the summary.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 9 entrant may not have been taught. In Chinese middle schools, biology starts in Grade 7 (cells, plants, the human body, digestion, breathing, food chains), physics in Grade 8 and chemistry only in Grade 9. A Year 9 entrant has usually done **some biology but no secondary physics or chemistry**. Questions 4 to 6 may not have been taught: mark NT rather than reading this as weak science, and judge the student's scientific thinking from questions 5 and 7.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Food webs	(a) grass (b) "It goes up" **and** fewer frogs eat them	(a) B1. (b) B1 for the tick with a correct reason; the tick alone scores 0.	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 食物网).
2	Photosynthesis word equation	oxygen	B1. Accept O_2.	Secure (Grade 7 biology), but the English words "glucose" and "carbon dioxide" may be new: read them aloud.
3	Digestion	C (small intestine)	B1	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 消化和吸收).
4	Elements, compounds and mixtures	(a) B (b) C	B1 each	Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught.
5	Conservation of mass	150.0 g	B1. Accept 150.	Grade 9 chemistry (质量守恒定律): may not have been taught, but a good scientific thinker can reason it from "nothing can get in or out".
6	Current in a series circuit	0.3 A	B1	Series circuits are Grade 9 physics: may not have been taught; simple circuits are met in primary.
7	Electromagnet: fair test and pattern in a table	(a) One control variable: the same battery (or voltage), the same nail, the same kind of paper clips, the same wire (b) 12	B1 each. (a) Do not accept "number of turns" (the variable he changes) or "number of paper clips" (what he measures).	Electromagnets are met in some primary textbooks and in Grade 9 physics; the working scientifically skills are the main point.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Not tested this year (not enough time): metals and non-metals in the periodic table, combustion and word equations, aerobic respiration, heating and cooling (conduction, convection, radiation).

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (questions 5 and 7): a student who explains a fair test and spots the pattern in a table is likely to do well once taught, even with several NT questions.

- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (producer, compound, mixture, ammeter) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know.
- **Strong responses** give the reason as well as the answer in question 1(b) and name a sensible control variable in question 7(a).

6. Score summary

Copy to `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`, and write "v2" beside the scores there: the version 2 listening is out of 16 and the maths has three sub-scores.

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	___ / 16 (Part A ___ / 8, Part B ___ / 8)	A B C D E	
Reading paper	___ / 24 (A ___ / 8, B ___ / 8, C ___ / 8)	A B C D E	
Sentence reading (shared record)	points ___ / 72; reading age _____	indicative: A B C D E	Meaning checks: Fluency:
Writing (task A or B)	___ / 16 (content ___, vocabulary ___, grammar ___, spelling and punctuation ___)	A B C D E	
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	___ / 30 (Fluency ___ / 10, Word questions ___ / 8, Applied ___ / 12)	1 2 3 4	NT: L: Profile:
Science	___ / 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Overall English (the band most skills sit in; name any skill two or more bands lower)		A B C D E	

Assessor's comment (strengths, English barrier or not, NT topics and the likely maths and science band once taught, the maths profile, anything to follow up):

Assessor signature and date _____

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Student interview and suitability record: Years 7 to 10

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (3 to 5 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___ (details on the sentence reading record)

2. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes: what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?	
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?	
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?	
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.	
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?	
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?	
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?	
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?	
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?	
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?	
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?	
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?	
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?	
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?	
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?	
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?	
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?	
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.	
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?	
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?	
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?	
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?		

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best. Use the evidence from the whole interview.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

4. Suitability

Rate each strand from what you saw and heard. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning).

Interviewer signature and date

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 10: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 10 v2: fluency)	Word problems (v2: word questions)	Applied (v2 only)	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___	___ / 12		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**					

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 10 v2: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The v2 papers are harder, so their band boundaries are lower (guide and booklets). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. In the Years 7 to 10 v2 papers, a student strong in fluency and word questions but weak in applied problems needs teaching in problem solving, not more content. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			